

Carrying progress home: everyday strategies

Skills grow fastest when they are practiced in everyday life. These strategies are widely used and easy to start, but check with your child's BCBA first so home and therapy stay consistent.

Use the same words as the team

Ask which words, signs or prompts your child's team uses, and use the same ones at home. Consistency helps skills carry over.

Example: If the team says “first shoes, then park,” say it the same way.

Catch the good moments

Notice what your child does well and praise it right away, and specifically.

Example: “You asked for help with words. Great asking!”

Make the day predictable

Visual schedules and first-then statements show what comes next and make transitions easier.

Example: A row of pictures by the door: shoes, backpack, car.

Offer real choices

Two clear options give your child control and practice communicating.

Example: “Apple or crackers?” while holding up both.

Create reasons to communicate

Set up small moments where your child needs to ask, then pause and wait.

Example: Put a favorite toy in sight but out of reach, and wait for a request in any form: words, signs, a picture or an AAC device.

Keep a simple log

Jot down what worked, what didn't and when. Share it at your next parent training.

Every voice counts

Words, signs, pictures, gestures and devices are all your child's voice. Respond to every form of communication.

Want help choosing where to start? Email info@autismkin.com.